

Nebius Group (NBIS): Key investor questions ahead of 2QCY26 earnings

EUROPE TECHNOLOGY: HARDWARE

Analysing the role of European AI enablers and updating our view on long-term upside potential

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Nebius will report its 2Q26 earnings on August 12, and we summarise the key themes investors are focused on and our latest perspectives going into the print. Key focus areas include: 1) Implications of strong pricing and demand environment for current and future year ARR, 2) Views on newsflow around Meta developing its own cloud business and the extent to which this could or could not increase competitive pressure on Nebius, 3) Commentary on latest demands in Nebius's core AI business focused on Enterprise and AI start-ups given instances of increasing emphasis on token maxing at some companies, and 4) Proofpoints on capacity expansion ramp and any potential regulatory challenges, and 5) Incremental colour on its announcement to provide AI compute infrastructure to partners. We remain Buy.

■ **Implications of strong pricing and demand environment for current and future year ARR:**

We believe that investors will remain focused on the extent to which a strong demand and pricing environment could affect the company expectations for 2026 revenue guidance. We note that Nebius at its 1Q26 results highlighted that demand for AI Infrastructure remains strong and the company sold out its capacity even at higher pricing. As such, we note that recent commentary from key AI players further reinforces our view that the demand for AI Infrastructure continues to outstrip supply which is a positive for Neocloud players such as Nebius. Additionally, we highlight that beyond just the pricing tailwinds Nebius's contract quality has also improved materially in 2026, with longer duration contracts across both new and existing customers as well as an increasing trend of prepayments to secure future capacity. As such, we note that Visible Alpha Consensus Data is modelling 2026 revenues of \$3.36bn (vs guidance of 2026 revenues between \$3.0-3.4bn). More broadly, we will look for incremental colour on the key puts and takes affecting NBIS's 2026 guidance.

■ **Views on newsflow around Meta developing its own cloud business and the extent to which this could or could not increase competitive pressure on Nebius:**

We saw an increase in investor questions around the Meta newsflow and the extent to which Nebius believes this could increase the competitive pressure in the space. As such, we note that Nebius's business model is based on offering a

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full AI platform experience as opposed to just bare-metal capacity. In this vein, the company at its recent Inflection event (see more details [here](#)) highlighted multiple competitive advantages such as better responsiveness, a more focused product offering spanning compute, storage and orchestration, direct access to engineering expertise, and flexible contract structures for customers managing uncertain project timelines which in our view differentiates its offering in the Neocloud space. As such, we will look for further commentary on how Nebius views the evolving competitive landscape.

- **Commentary on latest demands in Nebius's core AI business focused on Enterprise and AI start-ups given instances of increasing emphasis on token maxing at some companies:** Investors will focus on the trajectory of Nebius's Enterprise and AI start-up ramp in terms of new customer onboarding, in our view, given the company's continued focus on scaling this part of the business (as contrasted with its multi-year Hyperscaler deals). Additionally, the company signed new deals with Enterprise customers last quarter (such as Monday.com and Revolut) and investors will look for further proofpoints around continued demand momentum, in our view. Finally, while some investors have queried whether recent trends of token maxing could be a headwind for Nebius's revenues, we note that the company's business model has always focused on improving the cost dynamics (with falling cost per tokens, with new model releases in the past having actually led to further uptake of AI compute and revenue acceleration for Nebius, something we believe will continue happening). Further, we continue to believe that the Nebius AI platform represents a viable solution for Enterprises aiming to scale their business.
- **Proofpoints on capacity expansion ramp and any potential regulatory challenges:** We believe that investors remain focused on the execution of Neoclouds in ramping capacity as demand continues to outstrip supply, and the extent to which the company sees any regulatory issues acting as potential bottlenecks. We note that Nebius continues to deliver on the scaling of its infrastructure footprint, with contracted power exceeding >3.5GW in 1Q26 and the company now targeting >4GW of contracted power by year-end. Furthermore, the company at its Inflection event highlighted that it uses a portfolio-based approach to capacity planning whereby power targets for any given site are based on grid power levels rather than alternative energy source potential (with hydrocarbons treated as upside). As such, we will look for an update on the ramp of recently announced sites, power connectivity milestones and its latest views on any potential regulatory bottlenecks across the footprint.
- **Incremental colour on its announcement to provide AI compute infrastructure to partners:** Investors will look for incremental colour on the specifics of Nebius's newly announced asset-light model to provide its full-stack AI cloud platform to infrastructure partners. In July 2026, Nebius announced a new business model that allows infrastructure partners to deploy Nebius's full-stack AI cloud platform within their own AI data centers. As such, we will look for further specifics on the economics of these arrangements as well as levels of customer interest.

Valuation and key risks

We are Buy rated on Nebius with a 12-month price target of \$286 based on a 9x CY27E EV/Sales multiple. Key risks to our view and price target include competitive pressure from Hyperscalers, slower-than-expected adoption of AI and reduced visibility from shorter-term contracts.

NBIS	12m Price Target: \$286.00	Price: \$187.97	Upside: 52.2%
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Buy		GS Forecast			
Market cap: \$58.1bn Enterprise value: \$74.4bn 3m ADTV: \$4.3bn Netherlands European Semiconductors, Hardware and Gaming Tech M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes	Revenue (\$ mn)	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	EBIT (\$ mn)	529.8	3,585.7	13,710.5	24,472.4
	EPS (\$)	(596.3)	(3,519.4)	(1,604.1)	4,184.8
	EV/sales (X)	0.41	(10.31)	(10.06)	6.04
	EV/EBITDA (X)	30.4	18.1	6.1	3.3
	P/E (X)	NM	38.9	8.4	4.4
	FCF yield (%)	146.7	NM	NM	31.1
	Org. sales grth (%)	(24.9)	(38.2)	(49.1)	4.7
		–	–	–	–
	EPS (\$)	3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
		2.01	(4.52)	(4.64)	(3.16)

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 7 Aug 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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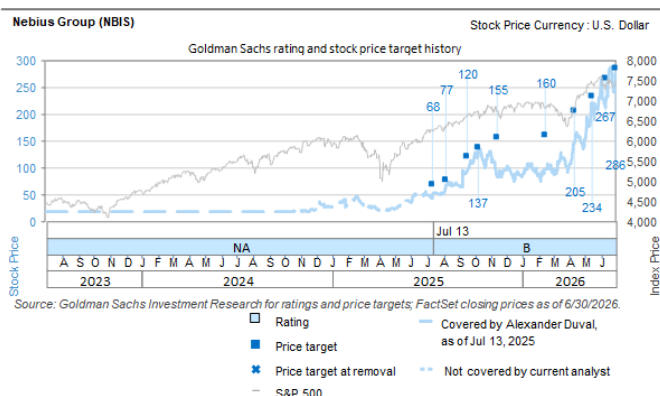
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Nebius Group (NBIS)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
29-Jun-26	286.00	261.15
10-Jun-26	267.00	211.69
15-May-26	234.00	219.94
13-Apr-26	205.00	154.56
15-Feb-26	160.00	98.01
14-Nov-25	155.00	83.54
08-Oct-25	137.00	122.00
17-Sep-25	120.00	94.08
08-Aug-25	77.00	68.78
13-Jul-25	68.00	44.30

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